

TRAFFICK PROBLEMS

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Today, I want to talk about something very troubling and problematic: human trafficking. More specifically, I want to discuss female sex trafficking. The point of this essay is merely to raise awareness since I have no viable solution to the problem. While men are also trafficked and women are trafficked for purposes other than sex, this essay is exclusively focused on female sex trafficking.

The first problem is that there never seems to be enough evidence to prove that trafficking is occurring even when it's happening right out in the open. There's always some other possible explanation. It seems as long as any other explanation exists, it's automatically more probable than trafficking. That's bullshit and I'm going to tell you why.

BACKGROUND

I've had a lot more exposure to the underbelly of human trafficking than the overwhelming majority of people, especially among those who feel at liberty to discuss it.

Because of reasons, I have literally been inside a sex trafficking operation,

gained the trust of the men operating it, and had the opportunity to chat with the girls when there was no expectation for them to perform.

It's not as though that option weren't presented to me. The men were more than happy to share their women because to them it's like bragging. Jealousy doesn't cross their minds. And it's not even about money. They would let me have any girl I wanted for free just for the satisfaction of me knowing first-hand the quality of their merchandise.

This could have been a potentially tense situation. But without missing a beat, I pulled the, "They are very lovely, but I'm a priest" card. Thankfully, they accepted that and didn't make any further offers. They didn't know that Thelemic priests are the opposite of celibate and I wasn't going to educate them for obvious reasons.

One of the reasons that I didn't flip tables in this situation is that I didn't want to die in that moment. The other reason is that the girls didn't seem distressed and showed no signs of physical abuse or anything of that sort. Although, thinking about it, I suppose a bruised apple commands a lower price, so that wouldn't be in their best interest. Nevertheless, I can't speak to exactly what means of psychological coercion were at play.

The operation was setup in an apartment that was leased by one of the girls. So, if you thought this was going to be a neat and tidy situation for you to wrap your head around, I regret to tell you that this is real life. I'm not making this up. Real life is complicated.

IT'S VERY COMPLICATED

So did she amass a debt she couldn't pay or did she simply lose her job and he came in to rescue her? I have no idea. But there was clearly leverage being applied in some kind of way. But I really didn't detect a brutal kind of abduction vibe. It was definitely more along the lines of financial coercion.

A large part of what this essay is about is getting you to see that trafficking doesn't always happen by abducting someone at random from a Walmart parking lot. I would argue that that kind of thing is the vast minority of cases.

Traffickers can absolutely present themselves as saviors to bail a girl out of a hard situation.

This is why the word trafficking is even difficult to define. What exactly constitutes coercion? This is a problem that that District Attorneys all over the country are wrestling with trying to get convictions against these guys. Because the whole thing depends on such convoluted psychological dynamics, often the girls will honestly believe that they are participating voluntarily and will refuse to assist police in making a case against their trafficker.

And here's the deeply uncomfortable question: *How do we define trafficking without it being essentially the same as employment?*

IT'S VERY SIMPLE

While it's certainly easy to get wound up trying to unravel the coercion and brainwashing at play in these cases, it's actually quite simple to identify the root cause and unravel the whole scheme permanently.

If the following things were true, trafficking would end tomorrow:

1. Society subsidizes all basic human needs: housing, clothing, healthcare, etc.
2. Prostitution is legal and regulated.
3. All drugs are made legal, taxed, and regulated just like alcohol.

That's it. That cuts off every avenue a trafficker can use to exploit vulnerable women.

IT'S VERY PERSONAL

I have a friend who went missing in 2012. She had amassed a considerable drug debt and went into a rehabilitation facility presumably because she knew they were looking for her and she figured she would be safe there. She was. But you can't remain in rehab forever. She was out for about a week and then suddenly disappeared.

Her name is Sarah Katherine Lewis. She published two books that are still available on Amazon: *Indecent: How I Make It and Fake It as a Girl For Hire* and *Sex and Bacon: Why I Love Things That Are Very, Very Bad for Me*. You might recognize her name from the acknowledgments of both *Liber Luminis* and *Liber Umbrae*.

Now you know the story that those books didn't tell. Sarah was a brilliant author and genuinely inspired me. My books wouldn't be what they are without her influence.

All Sarah wanted was to put the sex industry behind her and regain her agency. She was a very big personality and very outspoken. Her career as an author was taking off and she was doing many interviews and podcasts. Then it just suddenly stopped.

A public record search reveals that she has not had a residence since 2012. She hasn't taken out any loans, been arrested, gotten a parking ticket, or even renewed her driver's license since then. There is also no record of her death.

So, do I know that she was abducted by traffickers? No, I don't. But I challenge anyone to invent a more plausible scenario.

The part that keeps me up at night is wondering what traffickers do when a woman ages to the point that she's unable to bring in more money than she costs.

IT'S VERY PRESENT

Last night, I was walking around downtown Austin. Sixth Street, in particular, is packed with couples as well as single men and women. But almost every night I'll see one couple that looks wrong.

I know no one else sees it. Or if they do, they write it off as a couple who just had a bad night or whatever. But I know the signs. Even better, I know the vibe. I can read the subtle energy and it's unmistakable.

I see women being trafficked nearly *every night* in one of America's most

progressive cities.

It breaks my heart because I can't do anything about it. Attempting to intervene would just put both she and I in needless danger. So, I just let them walk past and try not to make eye contact, not that she would anyway.

I considered including a list of signs that someone is being trafficked. But it's not that simple. A list could improve your odds of being able to spot it, but that still leaves a margin of error. You have to have experienced the fingerprint of the emotional energy to spot it with any degree of certainty.

So here we sit in our mutual discomfort without any tidy or clean resolution.

According to the International Labor Organization, 6.3 million people were sex trafficked worldwide in 2021. There exists no reliable metrics for America, specifically that I could find.

For perspective, at the height of American slavery, there were just under 4 million enslaved people in the United States.

I would just like to leave you with one final question: Considering the national outrage over the girl being raped at Cornell University in September 2026, where is the outrage for the 6.3 million women and girls who are experiencing that on a daily basis?